Norris Davis III

Curriculum Vitae

Charles and Louise Travers Department of Political Science, University of California, Berkeley
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Education

Ph.D., Political Science (ABD), University of California, Berkeley — Expected 2027
Dissertation: *The Ideological Landscape of Black Media in the New Media Era*
Committee: Eric Schickler and Gabriel Lenz (Co-chairs), Taeku Lee, Omar Wasow
Fields: Race and Ethnic Politics, Political Behavior, American Politics

M.A., Political Science, University of California, Berkeley — 2021

B.A., Political Science and African American Studies, *summa cum laude*, The University of Alabama — 2019

Research Interests

Race and Ethnic Politics, Political Communication, Black Media, Political Behavior, Media and Politics, Sexuality and Politics, Public Opinion, Computational Text Analysis, AI and Politics

Fellowships and Awards

Black in AI Safety and Ethics (BASE) Research Fellowship — 2026–2027
Cyber and Innovation Policy Institute, U.S. Naval War College; mentored by Frank L. Smith III

Lee Ann Fujii DFP Travel Grant, American Political Science Association — 2026

Graduate Division Chancellor's Fellowship, UC Berkeley — 2019–Present

APSA Minority Fellowship Program, American Political Science Association — 2020

Job Market Paper

"The World's Most Dangerous Morning Show: Political Meaning in Black Entertainment Media."
Census of 131 political elite appearances on *The Breakfast Club* (2015–2026) and an audited, validated LLM content analysis of 5,518 episodes (~180,000 passages), distinguishing direct and ambient political framing.

Working Papers

"Strange Roommates: Discursive Integration in Black Media." — 2025

"Civic Density: How the Supply of Civic Opportunity Shapes Political Participation." With Christian Hosam (Wellesley College). — 2026

Works in Progress

Strange Roommates: Politics and Entertainment in Black Media. Book project.
Interviews with hosts, producers, and programmers at Black audio and digital outlets; focus groups with regular listeners.

Conference Presentations

"Strange Roommates: Discursive Integration in Black Media." Invited iPoster, American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Vancouver, BC. — September 2025

"Strange Roommates: Discursive Integration in Black Media." National Conference of Black Political Scientists Annual Meeting. Panel: "What's the 411? Black News and Media." — March 2025

Teaching Experience

Graduate Student Instructor, Charles and Louise Travers Department of Political Science, UC Berkeley

POLSCI 109B: The Politics of Public Policy — Summer 2026
Average student rating: 6.88/7

POLSCI 169: Experiments in Political Science — Spring 2026
Average student rating: 6.33/7

POLSCI 161: Public Opinion, Voting and Participation — Fall 2025
Average student rating: 6.69/7

POLSCI 1: Introduction to American Politics — Spring 2025
Average student rating: 6.54/7

POLSCI 161: Public Opinion, Voting and Participation — Fall 2024
Average student rating: 6.48/7

POLSCI 109B: The Politics of Public Policy — Spring 2023
Average student rating: 5.71/7

POLSCI 1: Introduction to American Politics — Fall 2022
Average student rating: 5.94/7

POLSCI 109Z: Crime and Democracy — Spring 2021
Average student rating: 5.78/7

POLSCI 116J: Black Political Thought — Fall 2020
Average student rating: 6.93/7

Research and Policy Experience

Black in AI Safety and Ethics (BASE), Research Fellow — 2026–2027
Cyber and Innovation Policy Institute, U.S. Naval War College. Building and analyzing a corpus of AI safety writing with embeddings, topic modeling, and LLM classification to map catastrophic and present-day risk discourse.

Color of Change, Senior Campaign Researcher (Contract) — 2024
Directed research on election misinformation and algorithmic bias for 7M+ member campaigns, including tracking AI-generated misinformation aimed at Black voters during the 2024 cycle.

Campaign Zero, Campaign Analyst (Contract) 2023–2024
Developed evidence-based policy recommendations on criminal justice reform.

Methods Training

Quantitative Analysis in Political Research I and II; Experimental Design; Voting Behavior and Public Opinion; Formal Models; Advanced Study in Race and Ethnic Relations (UC Berkeley)

University Service

Research Workshop in American Politics (RWAP), Coordinator, UC Berkeley 2020–2021
Fall 2020 through Spring 2021.

UC Berkeley Graduate Assembly, Legislative Director
Managed policy advocacy and represented graduate student interests to university administration; drafted resolutions and coordinated the legislative agenda.

Bx4 (Black Bears, Brown Bears), Coordinator
Coordinated programming and logistics for a departmental diversity initiative, including admissions events and community wellness programming.

Technical Skills

R, Python, SQL, Stata; LLM annotation pipelines and validation; embeddings and topic modeling; Qualtrics, Prolific; statistical modeling; survey design

References

Eric Schickler (Co-chair)
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Gabriel Lenz (Co-chair)
Professor of Political Science, UC Berkeley
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Taeku Lee
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Omar Wasow
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